

I AM FIGHTING FOR HUMANITY

DEFORESTATION

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

Chico Mendes (1944–88)

BEFORE

1100–1500 Temperate forest is cleared across large parts of western and central Europe.

1600–1900 Forests are cut down in North America to make room for agriculture.

Late 1970s Tropical rainforest clearance, mostly for ranching, accelerates dramatically.

AFTER

2008 The UN launches its Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD) incentive program.

2010 The US converts $21 m (£16 m) of Brazil's debt into a fund that will protect Brazil's coastal rainforest.

2015 The UN Paris Agreement sets targets for planting trees to offset the threat of climate change and global warming.